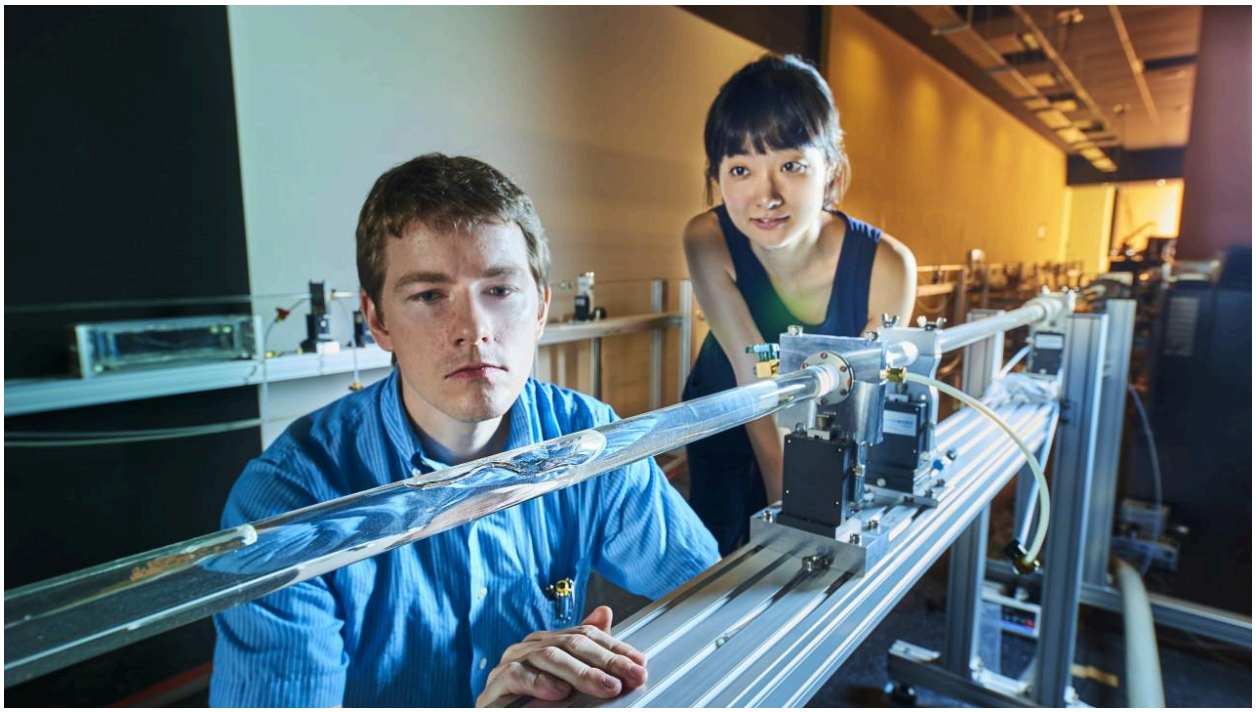
Apply to Research Internship

A research internship at OIST gives students experience working in a research environment directed by OIST faculty.



Selection Schedule

Application Round	Application Deadline	Result Announcement	Period of Internship
Fall 2026 Internship	April 15th, 2026, 23:59 (JST UTC+9)	Mid-June 2026	Between October 1st, 2026 - March 31st, 2027

Spring 2027 Internship	October 15th, 2026, 23:59 (JST UTC+9)	Mid-December 2026	Between April 1st, 2027 - September 30th, 2027

*An internship duration can be a minimum of 3 months to a maximum of 6 months within one Period of Internship.

*Applications for the Fall 2026 Internship are now open. Please proceed with preparing your application and ensure it is ready for submission. The submission period is now open and runs until April 15th, 2026.

*The schedule is tentative and subject to change

Eligibility

Those who are currently enrolled in their last two years of a bachelor's degree, enrolled in any year of a master's degree in universities, colleges, junior colleges, and vocational schools in Japan or overseas, or those who have graduated with a bachelor's or master's degree, are eligible to apply for the Research Internship at OIST.

If you will be in your final two years of a bachelor's degree by the start of the proposed internship duration, you are also eligible to apply.

Currently enrolled students must have approval from their home institution. The academic background of applicants should be appropriate to their desired host unit(s) at OIST.

Our Research Internship is intended for those who need more research experience and who are interested in joining OIST's PhD Program later. Current or graduated PhD students who wish to collaborate with OIST should look for other opportunities such as Workshops or Careers at OIST.

Research Interns who belong to a Japanese university/institution are required to prepare and bring their own insurances when accepted to the OIST Research Internship Program. Acceptable insurances are the combination of Gakkensai and Gakkenbai, or other insurances with similar coverage.

Application Procedure

We only accept application documents online. To apply for the program, you must create an account.

Please prepare all required documents in English, save them as a PDF file, and upload them to the application website. You can complete the application in one session or save your progress and return to finish it later.

Note: We recommend using a computer when preparing the online application. If you prefer using a mobile device, please make sure to have the latest operating system for the application website to work properly.

Application Documents

1. **Transcript and Diploma**

   Scanned copies of your current academic transcript and any other transcript from your past degree (BSc, MSc, etc.) along with completed diploma (BSc, MSc, etc.) in PDF format.

   - A scan of an unofficial transcript or other record of grades may be uploaded to the application website.
   - English explanation is required for transcripts that are not written in English.
   - If you have not graduated and do not have a diploma yet, please upload a certificate of enrollment from your institution, preferably indicating your expected graduation date.

2. **Statement of Purpose**

   This should be no more than 400 words (2500 characters) and should address the following points:

   - How does OIST and your desired research unit(s) fit with your current expertise and skill set? If you are interested in multiple research units, please explain your interest and fit for each unit briefly within one single statement.
   - What do you hope to accomplish at OIST?

- How does a research internship at OIST fit into your overall career plans/aspirations?

3. **Curriculum Vitae (CV)**

   Please provide a current CV summarizing your academic background, research experience, skills, and accomplishments. You may use any standard CV format.

4. **Recommendation Letter**

   Applicants must submit 1 to 3 letters of recommendation in English from professorial-level faculty who know you and can describe your academic potential as a researcher. Letters from lab members or postdocs are not eligible. You may submit your application only after at least one recommendation letter is received in the application system. Please note that OIST does not accept direct submissions from applicants.

5. **Passport**

   The application system requires applicants to provide their passport number and upload a scan of the passport photo page. It is essential for applicants from outside Japan to have a valid passport for travel to Japan. Ensure that you include your passport details during the application process. If you do not have a passport at the time of application, you can upload other government-issued identification documents instead.

6. **ID Photo**

   Please upload a recent photo taken within the last three months, showing your face from the front in standard passport orientation.

7. **English Proficiency Score (optional)**

   An English Proficiency Score (iELTS/TOEFL) is not required for the Research

Internship application. However, you may upload it if you believe it to strengthen your application.

Application Fee

The application fee for the Research Internship Program is **3,000 JPY**. It is not refundable on any circumstances, nor are fee waivers offered for personal financial situations at this time.

** If you have trouble paying due to international sanctions on your country, please use our Contact Us page describing your situation. Please use "Research Internship" as your reason to contact.*

Research Internship Program Description

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Research Internship FAQ

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Research Internship Program Faculty and Project Availability

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